



Apartment Plant Catalog

Edible & decorative plants for every small-space growing situation

\$14

Open-pollinated • Community-grown • Food sovereignty for everyone

The Apartment Plant Catalog

Edible and Decorative Plants for People with Limited Space and Big Goals

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You do not need a yard. You need light, containers, and the right plants for the space you actually have. This catalog gives you both categories — the plants that feed you and the ones that make your apartment feel like somewhere worth living.

Important Notice

This catalog is educational content based on real growing experience. Your results will vary depending on your specific light, space, and environmental conditions. It is not professional agricultural or horticultural advice. Use it as a practical reference and adjust based on what you observe in your own growing environment.

How to Use This Catalog

This catalog is organized into two sections: **Edible Plants** and **Decorative Plants**. Each entry includes everything you need to make a decision and succeed — light requirements, water needs, temperature tolerance, container specs, display options, care instructions, and common problems.

Before you buy anything, do this:

Step 1: Know your light. Stand at each of your windows at noon on a clear day. South-facing windows get the most direct light — the longest duration and highest intensity. West-facing get strong afternoon sun. East-facing get gentle morning sun. North-facing get no direct sun at all. This single factor determines which plants will thrive and which will struggle.

Step 2: Know your space. Do you have a south-facing windowsill? A balcony or fire escape? A dark corner that needs something living? A kitchen counter that gets moderate indirect light? Each of these is a different growing environment with different possibilities.

Step 3: Know your habits. Are you the kind of person who will remember to water every few days, or are you the kind who forgets for a week? Be honest. Some plants are forgiving. Others aren't.

Understanding Light Requirements

Throughout this catalog, light is described using the following scale:

Full Sun / High Light — 6+ hours of direct sunlight per day, or equivalent grow light. Required for most herbs and virtually all fruiting vegetables. A south-facing window usually qualifies. Without this, tomatoes, peppers, basil, and most fruiting crops will disappoint.

Bright Indirect / Medium-High Light — 4–6 hours near a window, no direct sun on the leaves, or light filtered through a sheer curtain. Suitable for strawberries, compact greens, and many decorative foliage plants.

Moderate / Indirect Light — Light from a window without direct sun hitting the plant. East or north-facing window, or a few feet back from a south/west window. Many houseplants thrive here.

Low Light — Fluorescent lighting, filtered light from a distant window, or a shaded room. A small number of very adaptable plants survive and even thrive here. Most edibles do not.

Grow Light Note: If your apartment lacks strong natural light, a full-spectrum LED grow light changes everything. For edibles, position the light 6–12 inches above plants and run it 14–16 hours per day. For most foliage houseplants, 12–14 hours at 12–18 inches is sufficient. Grow lights are the great equalizer for apartment growing.

A Note on Watering

Overwatering kills more houseplants than any other single cause. When in doubt, wait. A healthy plant with slightly dry soil will recover. A plant with waterlogged roots may not.

The one exception: edible greens, herbs, and fruiting plants actively growing in warm conditions need consistent moisture. For these, the soil should stay evenly moist — not soggy, not bone dry.

For cacti, succulents, ZZ plants, snake plants, and most drought-tolerant decoratives: water thoroughly when the soil is completely dry, then leave them alone.

SECTION ONE: EDIBLE PLANTS

HERBS

Basil (*Ocimum basilicum*)

The indispensable warm-season herb. The most rewarding plant you can grow in a sunny kitchen.

Light	Full sun — 6+ hours direct or grow light
Water	Consistently moist; do not allow to dry
Temperature	65–85°F; dies below 50°F
Container	6–8" pot with drainage
Display	Windowsill, counter under grow light, st
Growing Season	Year-round indoors with adequate light

Varieties to Consider

- Sweet Basil — The standard. Large leaves, classic flavor. Best for pesto, pasta, caprese.
- Thai Basil — Narrower, slightly anise-flavored leaves. More heat-tolerant than sweet basil. Essential for Thai and Vietnamese cooking.
- Purple/Dark Opal Basil — Striking purple foliage with a slightly spicier flavor. Excellent in vinegars and as a garnish.
- Lemon Basil — Bright citrus aroma. Excellent with fish, in salads, or steeped in simple syrup.

Uses: Culinary — pesto, pasta, pizza, salads, sandwiches, cocktails. One plant provides enough leaves for regular kitchen use. Several plants give you enough for batch pesto.

Detailed Care

Plant in the sunniest window you have or directly under a grow light. A south-facing window is borderline adequate in summer; grow light is more reliable year-round. Basil in low light grows tall, leggy, and virtually flavorless — the plant puts its energy into reaching for light rather than producing aromatic oils.

Water consistently and thoroughly. Basil does not like to dry out. In a 6" pot in warm weather, this may mean watering every 1–2 days.

Pinch constantly. This is the single most important basil care habit. Every time a stem reaches 6–8 leaves, pinch off the top two pairs. This keeps the plant bushy, full, and producing new leaves. The moment you see flower buds forming at the tips, pinch them off immediately. Once basil flowers and goes to seed, leaf production slows and the flavor deteriorates. Your job is to keep that from happening for as long as possible.

Propagation: Cuttings root readily in water in 1–2 weeks. Cut a 4" stem just below a leaf node, strip the lower leaves, and place in a glass of water on a bright windowsill. Transplant to soil when roots are 1–2" long.

Common Problems

- Leggy, pale growth: Not enough light
- Wilting despite wet soil: Root rot from sitting water — ensure drainage
- Powdery white coating on leaves: Powdery mildew, usually from poor air circulation. Remove affected leaves; improve airflow.

Mint (*Mentha* spp.)

Aggressive, vigorous, and incredibly useful. Grow it in its own pot — always.

Light	Moderate to bright indirect — 4–6 hours
Water	Consistently moist; keep soil from dryin
Temperature	65–75°F; cold-tolerant outdoors, not pic
Container	6–8" pot — never shared with other plant
Display	Windowsill, counter, bathroom (tolerates
Growing Season	Year-round indoors

Varieties to Consider

- Spearmint — Sweetest, most versatile. Best for teas, mojitos, and culinary use.
- Peppermint — More intense. Better for medicinal use, candy-making, strong teas.
- Chocolate Mint — Faint chocolate undertone. Excellent in desserts and hot chocolate.
- Apple Mint — Fruity, mild. Good for fruit salads, infused water, cocktails.

Uses: Tea (fresh or dried), cocktails, cooking, baking, digestive aid, topical (peppermint oil is a natural mild analgesic). The leaves freeze well — pack in ice cube trays with water for cocktail use.

Detailed Care

Mint is one of the easiest herbs to grow indoors and one of the most productive. Unlike most herbs, it tolerates lower light and cooler temperatures reasonably well, though it grows more vigorously in a bright spot.

The container rule is non-negotiable. Mint spreads aggressively by underground runners and will colonize neighboring pots or any planting bed. Keep it in its own pot.

Pinch frequently to keep plants bushy. Mint left unpinched will grow tall and floppy. Harvest from the top — cut stems back by a third whenever you need leaves, and the plant will branch and fill back in.

Mint prefers consistently moist soil. It is one of the few herbs that does not want to dry out between waterings.

Propagation: Incredibly easy. Place a 4–6" stem cutting in water; roots appear within days. Alternatively, divide an established plant — pull apart a section of root and replant.

Common Problems

- Rust (orange spots): Fungal issue; remove affected leaves, improve airflow
- Spreading into other pots: Keep all containers separated with a gap between them

Rosemary (*Salvia rosmarinus*)

Slow-growing, long-lived, and deeply rewarding. A rosemary plant well-tended can last years.

Light	Full sun — 6–8 hours direct
Water	Allow soil to dry between waterings; dro
Temperature	65–75°F ideal; cold-hardy varieties exis
Container	8–10" pot with excellent drainage
Display	South-facing windowsill, standalone
Growing Season	Year-round indoors; slower growth in win

Varieties to Consider

- Tuscan Blue — Upright, strong flavor. Classic rosemary.
- Arp — Cold-hardest variety. More tolerant of temperature swings.
- Spice Islands — Dense, compact, excellent flavor for cooking.
- Prostratus (Creeping Rosemary) — Trailing habit. Spectacular in hanging baskets or draped over pot edges.

Uses: Culinary — meats (lamb, chicken, pork), roasted vegetables, breads and focaccia, infused oils. Medicinal — anti-inflammatory, cognitive support. Cosmetic — hair rinses, beard/scalp oils. Decorative — evergreen, fragrant, beautiful in a pot.

Detailed Care

Rosemary needs more light than almost any other herb. A south-facing window is the minimum indoors; a grow light is a better option for most apartments.

The other critical factor is drainage. Rosemary grows natively in rocky Mediterranean hillsides with fast-draining, lean soil and dry summers. In a pot, this means: terracotta or well-draining container, a mix with at least 30% perlite, and a policy of underwatering rather than overwatering. If the roots sit in moisture, they rot.

Prune frequently and boldly. After each harvest or every 4–6 weeks, cut stems back by a third. This keeps the plant compact and productive. Without pruning, rosemary becomes a tall, woody shrub with leaves only at the tips.

Fertilize minimally — once per month during active growth with a diluted balanced fertilizer. Rosemary in rich, frequently fertilized soil produces fast growth but little flavor. Lean soil and stress produce aromatic intensity.

Propagation: Semi-hardwood cuttings in late spring to summer. Take a 4–6" cutting, strip the lower half, dip in rooting hormone, and plant in a moist, well-draining medium. Patience required — rooting takes 3–6 weeks. Far easier than starting from seed.

Common Problems

- Root rot: Overwatering or poor drainage — the most common killer
- Powdery mildew: Poor airflow; prune to improve circulation
- Leggy with leaves only at tips: Not pruning frequently enough

Thyme (*Thymus vulgaris*)

Hardy, forgiving, and surprisingly prolific in a sunny window.

Light	Full sun — 6+ hours direct
Water	Allow to dry between waterings; drought-
Temperature	65–75°F; tolerates wide range
Container	6" pot with excellent drainage
Display	Sunny windowsill, shared planter with or
Growing Season	Year-round indoors

Varieties to Consider

- Common Thyme — Standard culinary use. Classic flavor.
- Lemon Thyme — Bright citrus note. Excellent with fish, chicken, and desserts.
- Creeping Thyme — Low, spreading habit. Beautiful trailing over pot edges.
- Woolly Thyme — Soft grey foliage, more ornamental than culinary.

Uses: Culinary — soups, roasts, stocks, marinades, beans. Works fresh or dried. Medicinal — antibacterial, cough suppressant (thyme tea with honey is a traditional remedy). Companion plant — fragrant, insect-repellent.

Detailed Care

Thyme is one of the most low-maintenance herbs you can grow. It wants sun, lean soil, and infrequent water. It is far more likely to be killed by overwatering than by any other mistake.

Harvest regularly by snipping stem tips — 3–4" at a time. Regular harvest keeps the plant producing tender new growth. Left to its own devices, thyme becomes woody at the base with less leaf production over time.

Like rosemary, thyme prefers a leaner soil than most potting mixes provide. Add 20–30% perlite or coarse sand to improve drainage.

Propagation: Stem cuttings or seed. Cuttings are faster — root in 2–3 weeks in moist perlite. Division of established plants works well.

Chives (*Allium schoenoprasum*)

The most forgiving herb in this catalog. If you can't grow chives, look for a brighter window.

Light	Moderate to bright — 4–6 hours
Water	Keep consistently damp
Temperature	65–75°F; cold-tolerant
Container	6" pot; or cluster of 5–6 in an 8" pot
Display	Windowsill, kitchen counter
Growing Season	Year-round indoors; perennial

Varieties to Consider

- Common Chives — Mild onion flavor; hollow round stems; purple flowers (also edible)
- Garlic Chives — Flat leaves, more pronounced garlic-onion flavor; white flowers; excellent in Asian cooking

Uses: Culinary — garnish on eggs, soups, potatoes, dips, sour cream. Mild enough to eat raw by the handful. The flowers are edible and beautiful in salads. A flowering pot of chives is genuinely pretty.

Detailed Care

Chives grow in clumps from bulb-like roots and spread slowly over time. Harvest by cutting stems to within an inch of the soil — the plant regrows from the base. The more you cut, the more it produces, within reason.

Every 2–3 years, the clump becomes crowded. Divide it: pull the root mass apart into 2–4 sections and replant. This rejuvenates the plant and gives you more.

Allow the flowers to open fully before removing them — they're edible and ornamental. If you want to save seed or let the plant self-sow (outdoors), leave the flowers until they dry.

Propagation: Division, or direct seed. Seeds germinate easily in 2–3 weeks.

Parsley (*Petroselinum crispum*)

Slow to start, productive once established, and a nutritional powerhouse often used as just a garnish.

Light	Moderate to bright indirect — 4–6 hours
Water	Keep consistently moist
Temperature	65–75°F
Container	6–8" pot
Display	Windowsill, kitchen counter
Growing Season	Year-round indoors; biennial outdoors

Varieties to Consider

- Italian (Flat-leaf) Parsley — Stronger flavor, preferred for cooking
- Curly Parsley — Milder flavor, more decorative; classic garnish

Uses: Culinary — soups, stocks, tabbouleh, gremolata, sauces, chimichurri. Nutritionally dense — rich in vitamins K, C, and A. Often treated as a garnish and eaten in volumes that would actually constitute a significant nutritional contribution if anyone noticed.

Detailed Care

Parsley is a biennial — it grows leaves the first year and seeds the second. Indoors, treat it as a long-lived annual. The main challenge is germination: parsley seed is notoriously slow, often taking 2–3 weeks to sprout. Soak seeds in lukewarm water for 24 hours before planting to speed this up.

Once established, parsley is productive and relatively unfussy. Harvest outer stems first, cutting to the base of the stem (not just the top). This encourages continuous new growth from the center.

Propagation: Seed. Don't try to transplant established plants — parsley develops a long taproot and resents disturbance.

Cilantro (*Coriandrum sativum*)

Fast-growing, fast-bolting, and worth the succession planting strategy.

Light	Moderate — 4–6 hours
Water	Keep moderately moist
Temperature	55–70°F preferred; bolts quickly in heat
Container	6" pot or shallow window box
Display	Windowsill; east-facing window is ideal
Growing Season	Year-round; easier in cooler months

Varieties to Consider

- Santo — Slow-bolt variety; more leaf production before seeding
- Long-Standing — Similar slow-bolt traits; good choice
- Leisure — Bred specifically for leaf production

Uses: Culinary — Mexican, Indian, Thai, Vietnamese, and Middle Eastern cooking. Fresh leaves are the herb; dried seeds (coriander) are a separate spice. The roots are used in Thai cooking and have a more concentrated flavor than the leaves.

Detailed Care

Cilantro wants to bolt — that is, produce flowers and seeds — quickly. Heat accelerates this. In a warm apartment, a single planting may produce harvestable leaves for only 3–4 weeks before flowering.

The strategy: succession plant. Every 2–3 weeks, start a new pot of seeds. When one plant bolts, you have the next one ready. Alternatively, keep your apartment on the cooler side (below 70°F if possible) and use a slow-bolt variety — this extends the harvest window significantly.

When the plant does bolt and flower, let it. The flowers attract beneficial insects and the seeds are coriander, which you can use as a spice or save for the next planting.

Propagation: Direct seed only. Cilantro has a taproot and transplants very poorly.

Oregano (*Origanum vulgare*)

More flavorful when grown lean and dry. Ignore it and it rewards you.

Light	Full sun — 6+ hours
Water	Allow to dry between waterings
Temperature	65–75°F; fairly cold-tolerant
Container	6" pot with good drainage
Display	Sunny windowsill
Growing Season	Year-round indoors

Varieties to Consider

- Greek Oregano — Most pungent and flavorful; best for culinary use
- Italian Oregano — Milder, slightly sweet; good for pizza, pasta
- Golden Oregano — Variegated yellow-green foliage; ornamental value alongside culinary use

Uses: Culinary — pizza, pasta, marinades, Mediterranean cooking broadly. Medicinal — antimicrobial, antioxidant. Dries extremely well; dried oregano is actually more concentrated in flavor than fresh for most applications.

Detailed Care

Almost identical care to thyme: sun, lean soil, infrequent water. Oregano intensifies in flavor when slightly stressed — grown in rich, frequently watered soil, it produces abundant bland leaves. Grown lean in well-draining mix with minimal water, it produces intensely aromatic leaves.

Trim regularly to prevent woodiness. Like thyme and rosemary, oregano becomes increasingly woody at the base over time. Annual renewal pruning — cutting stems back by half in late winter — keeps the plant producing tender, flavorful growth.

Sage (*Salvia officinalis*)

One of the most beautiful herbs you can grow. Ornamental enough to deserve a prominent spot.

Light	Full sun — 6+ hours
Water	Allow to dry between waterings; drought-
Temperature	65–75°F; hardy to cold
Container	6–8" pot with excellent drainage
Display	Sunny windowsill; decorative standalone
Growing Season	Year-round indoors

Varieties to Consider

- Common Sage — Classic culinary use; grey-green leaves
- Purple Sage — Beautiful deep purple foliage; same flavor
- Golden Sage — Variegated green and gold; striking ornamental value
- Tricolor Sage — Purple, green, and cream variegation; one of the most beautiful herbs

Uses: Culinary — brown butter and sage sauce, stuffing, pork, chicken, beans, compound butter. Medicinal — digestive aid, sore throat tea, traditional memory support. Ceremonial — white sage and similar species are used for smudging, though harvest ethics around wildcrafted white sage are significant (see the native plants guide). For smudging purposes, growing your own common garden sage is a sustainable alternative.

Detailed Care

Sage wants the same conditions as rosemary — full sun, lean well-draining soil, infrequent water. It is somewhat more forgiving than rosemary but shares the same weakness: it will rot if its roots sit in wet soil.

Prune sage hard once per year in early spring, cutting back by half or more. Without annual pruning, sage becomes leggy and woody with diminishing leaf production. After a hard prune, it pushes vigorous new growth from the base.

VEGETABLES AND FRUITING PLANTS

Cherry Tomatoes (*Solanum lycopersicum*)

The most rewarding container edible you can grow, and one of the most demanding on light.

Light	Full sun — 8+ hours direct, or strong gr
Water	Consistently moist; do not allow to dry
Temperature	65–75°F day / 55–65°F night
Container	5-gallon minimum; 10-gallon preferred fo
Display	South-facing window, balcony, or directl
Growing Season	Spring through fall outdoors; year-round

Varieties to Consider (for containers)

- Tumbling Tom Red/Yellow — Compact trailing habit; ideal for hanging baskets
- Tiny Tim — Extremely dwarf (12"); fits a small pot; truly miniature
- Micro Tom — The smallest tomato plant that actually produces fruit (6–8"); houseplant tomato
- Patio F — Determinate, compact, reliable in containers
- Sun Gold (if space allows 5-gallon) — Intensely sweet orange cherry; one of the best-tasting tomatoes grown anywhere at any scale

Uses: Culinary — fresh eating, salads, roasted, pasta sauce, sun-dried. Growing your own gives you access to varieties unavailable in grocery stores, and the flavor difference between a vine-ripened home cherry tomato and a store-bought one is significant enough that many people who start growing them never stop.

Detailed Care

Light is the non-negotiable. Tomatoes need more light than almost any other plant in this catalog. A south-facing window in summer may be sufficient for cherry varieties; for anything larger, a grow light is not optional.

Start seeds 6–8 weeks before you plan to put them in their final location. Transplant into large containers — the larger the container, the more fruit. Fill with high-quality potting mix amended with slow-release fertilizer and a handful of worm castings or compost.

Once the plant begins to flower and set fruit, fertilize every 2 weeks with a tomato fertilizer (higher in phosphorus and potassium than nitrogen). Too much nitrogen in the fruiting stage produces lush green leaves and few tomatoes.

Hand-pollination: Indoors, there are no bees. Gently flick open flowers with your finger or a soft brush to transfer pollen, or use an electric toothbrush held near (not touching) the open flowers to vibrate them. Do this daily when flowers are open.

Determinate varieties (like Tiny Tim, Micro Tom) grow to a set size and produce all their fruit at once. Indeterminate varieties (like Sun Gold) keep growing and producing until killed by cold or disease.

Common Problems

- Blossom end rot (black leathery bottom on fruit): Calcium deficiency from inconsistent watering; water more evenly
- No fruit set: Low light or lack of pollination
- Spider mites (tiny dots on leaves, fine webbing): Low humidity; mist plants or increase humidity

Compact Peppers (*Capsicum annuum*)

Slower and more demanding than tomatoes, but the harvest is intensely rewarding.

Light	Full sun — 8+ hours; 6 minimum for fruit
Water	Consistently moist; avoid waterlogging
Temperature	70–85°F day, 60–70°F night; 60°F minimum
Container	3–5 gallon
Display	South-facing window, balcony, grow light
Growing Season	Spring through fall; year-round with gro

Varieties to Consider

- Lunchbox Orange/Red/Yellow — Sweet compact peppers; prolific in containers
- Jalapeño M — Compact jalapeño bred for container growing; strong heat
- Cayenne Dwarf — Small, ornamental, fiery. Beautiful in a pot.
- Fish Pepper — Heritage variety, variegated foliage; dramatic ornamental value alongside culinary
- NuMex Twilight — Ornamental chili; fruits change from purple to yellow to orange to red on the same plant; genuinely beautiful

Uses: Culinary — fresh, roasted, dried, pickled, hot sauce. Sweet peppers are a versatile vegetable. Hot peppers are infinitely variable in heat and flavor depending on variety. Growing your own opens access to hundreds of varieties no store will ever carry.

Detailed Care

Start seeds 8–10 weeks before last frost, or purchase transplants. Peppers are slower than tomatoes and more cold-sensitive — they want warmth consistently. A seedling heat mat during germination dramatically improves germination rates (70°F soil temperature minimum; 80–85°F ideal).

Peppers are somewhat more drought-tolerant than tomatoes but still want consistent moisture during fruiting. Hand-pollinate the same way as tomatoes.

A tip that dramatically increases yield: pinch off the first flower bud that forms, before the plant has established much foliage. This redirects energy into root and leaf development, resulting in a larger, more productive plant over the season.

Common Problems

- Blossom drop: Temperature swings, low humidity, or inconsistent watering
- Slow or no germination: Soil too cold; use a heat mat

Lettuce and Salad Greens (*Lactuca sativa*)

The fastest return on investment in container growing. From seed to salad in 30–45 days.

Light	Moderate — 5+ hours; grow light works we
Water	Consistently moist
Temperature	55–70°F preferred; bolts in heat above 7
Container	4–6" deep; window boxes work well
Display	Windowsill, under grow light, kitchen co
Growing Season	Year-round indoors; best in cooler month

Varieties to Consider

- Black Seeded Simpson — Fast-growing loose-leaf; heat-tolerant for lettuce; good starter
- Tom Thumb — Miniature butterhead; fits in very small spaces; sweet flavor
- Buttercrunch — Classic butterhead; tender, mild, excellent texture
- Lollo Rosso — Frilly red-tinged leaves; decorative and delicious
- Oakleaf — Deeply lobed leaves; bolt-resistant; good flavor
- Mesclun Mix — Blend of multiple varieties; complex flavor, interesting texture

Uses: Salads, wraps, sandwiches, garnish. Loose-leaf lettuce can be harvested continuously by cutting outer leaves — you don't have to harvest the whole head at once. A cut-and-come-again harvest from two or three pots, staggered by two weeks, can provide salad greens continuously.

Detailed Care

Lettuce is a cut-and-come-again crop at its best. Sow seeds thickly, thin to 4–6" apart, and begin harvesting outer leaves when plants are 4–6" tall. The plant will regrow from the center repeatedly.

Succession sow every two to three weeks for continuous harvest. A single sowing will exhaust itself or bolt in a month; three staggered sowings keeps you in greens.

Heat causes bolting (the plant shoots up a flower stalk and the leaves become bitter). Prevent this by keeping temperatures below 70°F if possible, using bolt-resistant varieties, and planning a spring and fall crop rather than attempting to grow through summer.

Kale (*Brassica oleracea*)

Slower than lettuce but more productive per plant over a long season.

Light	Moderate to bright — 5+ hours
Water	Consistently moist
Temperature	50–70°F preferred; cold-tolerant to 40°F
Container	6–8" deep pot
Display	Windowsill, balcony, standalone pot
Growing Season	Year-round indoors; prefers cool season

Varieties to Consider

- Lacinato (Dinosaur/Tuscan) Kale — Dark blue-green, crinkled, richly flavored; excellent in cooking
- Winterbor Curly Kale — Classic curly kale; productive; hardy
- Dwarf Blue Curly — Compact variety; better suited to smaller containers
- Scarlet Kale — Beautiful purple-red foliage; ornamental value equal to culinary

Uses: Culinary — raw salads (massage with olive oil and salt to soften), cooked greens, kale chips, smoothies, soups, stir-fry. Nutritionally one of the most dense vegetables you can grow.

Detailed Care

Harvest outer leaves first, allowing the center to continue growing. A single established kale plant will provide leaves for months if the center growing point is never harvested.

Unlike lettuce, kale is a slow-growing crop — allow 50–60 days from seed to first harvest. Start with a transplant if you want faster results.

Microgreens (various species)

No experience required. Fastest harvest of any plant in this catalog. High nutritional density in minimal space.

Light	5–6 hours minimum; grow light ideal
Water	Bottom watering or daily misting
Temperature	60–72°F
Container	Shallow tray, 1–2" depth
Display	Countertop, under grow light
Growing Season	Year-round; 7–14 day cycle

Best Varieties to Grow

- Radish — Fastest (5–7 days); peppery, spicy flavor; red stems
- Broccoli — 7–10 days; mild, nutritious; high in sulforaphane
- Sunflower — 10–12 days; thick, nutty, substantial stems; satisfying crunch
- Peas — 10–14 days; sweet pea flavor; long, beautiful shoots; one of the most delicious
- Mustard — 7–10 days; intensely spicy; use sparingly as a salad accent
- Amaranth — 8–12 days; striking red color; mild flavor; visually dramatic
- Basil Microgreens — 10–14 days; intensely basil-flavored; fragrant
- Corn — 10–14 days; sweet, tender; distinct from other microgreens

Uses: Salad garnish, sandwich layer, smoothie addition, avocado toast topping, soup garnish. Microgreens contain 4–40x the nutrient concentration of mature vegetables in some studies. They are also one of the few crops where the harvest cycle is short enough to see immediate results — useful for building confidence and habit before moving to longer-season crops.

Detailed Care

Microgreens require no soil experience and very little equipment. Use a shallow tray (recycled food containers work), any seed-starting or potting mix, and seeds.

Sow densely — much denser than you would for mature plants. Cover with a second tray for the first 2–3 days to create darkness and humidity, which drives fast germination. Once seeds sprout and you see the first shoots pushing up, remove the cover and move to light.

Water by pouring water into the bottom of the tray (if using a set of nested trays) or misting carefully from above. Avoid getting water on the seed leaves — this can cause damping off (fungal rot at the soil surface).

Harvest with scissors when the seed leaves are fully open and before the first true leaves appear — typically at 1–2" tall. Cut just above the soil surface. Rinse and use immediately or refrigerate for up to 5 days.

Start a new tray every week to maintain continuous harvest.

Strawberries (*Fragaria* spp.)

The hanging basket crop. Ornamental and edible, with fruit that tastes nothing like what you buy at the store.

Light	Bright indirect to full sun — 6+ hours p
Water	Consistently moist; shallow roots dry fa
Temperature	65–75°F day, 50–60°F night ideal
Container	12–14" hanging basket (4 plants); 8–10"
Display	Hanging basket, railing planter, tiered
Growing Season	Year-round indoors; everbearing/day-neut

Varieties to Consider

- Alpine Strawberry (*Fragaria vesca*) — Tiny, intensely flavored fruits; does not produce runners; very compact; easy from seed; grows in shadier conditions than most
- Mara des Bois — Day-neutral; produces continuously; wild strawberry flavor in a larger fruit; excellent for containers
- Monterey — Day-neutral; large fruit; productive in containers
- Elan — Day-neutral; compact; excellent balcony performer

Uses: Fresh eating, desserts, jams and preserves, baked goods. The flavor of a strawberry ripened on the plant and eaten immediately is genuinely different from anything available commercially — supermarket strawberries are bred for shelf life and uniformity, not flavor.

Detailed Care

Hanging baskets work exceptionally well because the runners — long trailing stems that produce new baby plants — can hang freely rather than rooting into neighboring containers. For productive fruit, remove runners; for propagation, let them develop and root them in small pots.

Strawberries have shallow root systems that dry out quickly, especially in hanging baskets in warm weather. Daily watering is often required in summer. A self-watering container with a reservoir dramatically reduces this maintenance burden.

Fertilize monthly with a balanced fertilizer until the first flowers appear, then switch to a low-nitrogen, higher-potassium fertilizer to encourage fruiting over leaf growth.

Propagation: Runners rooted in soil or water. Alpine strawberries can be started from seed.

Dwarf Citrus — Meyer Lemon (Citrus × meyeri)

A multi-year project with spectacular results. The fragrance of the flowers alone is worth the commitment.

Light	Full sun — 8–12 hours; south-facing wind
Water	When top 3" of soil are dry; excellent d
Temperature	65–70°F day, 55–60°F night; 45°F minimum
Container	12–18" diameter; 20–30 gallon capacity
Display	South-facing window, balcony, large stan
Growing Season	Year-round indoors; slower in winter

Other Dwarf Citrus Worth Considering

- Calamondin Orange — Smallest and most apartment-friendly dwarf citrus; prolific small orange fruits; intensely flavored rind; excellent for marmalade and cocktails; more cold-tolerant than Meyer lemon
- Kumquat (Nagami) — Eaten whole, skin and all; sweet skin, tart flesh; ornamental; relatively compact
- Kaffir Lime — Grown primarily for the leaves (essential in Thai cooking) rather than fruit; requires less fruiting sun; more manageable indoors

Uses: Culinary — fresh juice, cooking, baking, cocktails, preserved lemons (Meyer's thin skin is ideal for preserved lemon recipes), lemon curd, marinades. Ornamental — flowering citrus fills a room with fragrance; the fruit on the tree is beautiful for months.

Detailed Care

Purchase a grafted dwarf tree from a reputable nursery rather than attempting to grow from seed. Grafted trees produce fruit in 1–3 years; seed-grown trees may take 7–10 years.

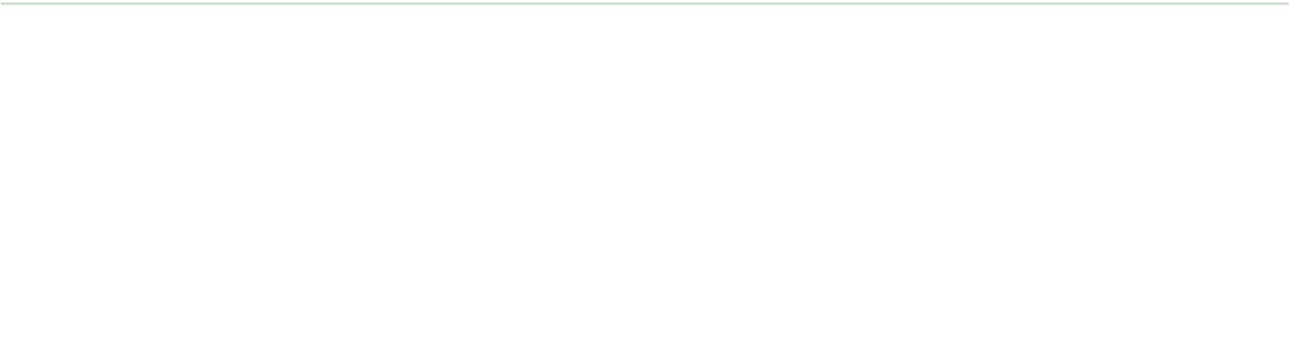
Citrus grown indoors requires hand-pollination when in flower. Using a small brush or cotton swab, transfer pollen from flower to flower. The fragrant white blossoms are not self-fertile without some mechanical assistance when there are no pollinators present.

Humidity matters. Citrus prefers 60–70% humidity — significantly higher than most apartments. Use a pebble tray filled with water, group plants together, or run a humidifier nearby. Low humidity causes leaf drop and fruit failure.

Repot every 2–3 years into a slightly larger container. Citrus in too-small containers becomes root-bound and produces poorly.

Common Problems

- Yellow leaves: Often iron or nitrogen deficiency; use citrus-specific fertilizer
- Leaf drop: Environmental change, cold, or low humidity
- No fruit: Insufficient light or pollination



Nasturtium (*Tropaeolum majus*)

The simplest edible flower you can grow. Thrives on neglect, ornamental, and every part is edible.

Light	Moderate — 4–6 hours; east-facing window
Water	Allow top 2" to dry; drought-tolerant
Temperature	55–75°F preferred
Container	8–12" pot or railing planter
Display	Hanging basket (trailing), railing plant
Growing Season	Year-round indoors; faster growth in spr

Varieties to Consider

- Empress of India — Deep red flowers, dark blue-green leaves; compact, upright
- Alaska Mix — Variegated cream-and-green leaves; makes the plant ornamental even without flowers
- Strawberries and Cream — Soft peach-and-cream flowers; long trailing vines; excellent in hanging baskets
- Jewel Mix — Compact, mixed colors; excellent for containers

Uses: Culinary — peppery flowers used in salads, on avocado toast, as garnish, pickled as capers (the seed pods); leaves have a mild watercress flavor and can be used in salads; seeds ground as a pepper substitute. Ornamental — brightly colored flowers for months. One of the few plants where the entire specimen — leaves, flowers, and seeds — is edible at every stage.

Detailed Care

Nasturtium is the forgiving gateway plant. It tolerates lower light than most edibles, prefers lean soil (over-fertilized nasturtium produces enormous leaves and no flowers), and actively thrives on irregular watering.

Sow large seeds directly in the final container — nasturtium has a taproot and transplants poorly. Seeds sprout in 7–12 days and the plant grows quickly.

Excessive fertilizer reliably produces large, beautiful leaves and no flowers. Lean soil is the secret.

Garlic — for greens and bulbs (*Allium sativum*)

Two crops in one: fast garlic greens and, with patience, full bulbs.

Light	6–8 hours for bulb production; 4+ hours
Water	Keep damp; allow top inch to dry
Temperature	60–75°F active growth
Container	12" deep minimum for bulbs; shallow for
Display	South-facing window, standalone pot
Growing Season	Plant in fall for spring harvest; greens

Quick Harvest — Garlic Greens: Plant individual cloves in any pot, 1" deep and 2–3" apart. In 2–3 weeks, you'll have slender green shoots (garlic chives, essentially) ready to snip and use. This is a fast, low-effort way to keep garlic flavor available in the kitchen.

Full Bulb Production: Plant in fall, keep cool through winter, and harvest when lower leaves yellow (6–9 months). Apartment growing of full garlic bulbs is possible but requires patience and a cool, distinct rest period that mimics outdoor conditions.

Varieties to Consider

- Softneck varieties — Longer storage life; larger bulbs; good for apartment growers
- Elephant Garlic — Technically a leek relative; very large, mild cloves; easier to work with; equally good for greens

Uses: Culinary — everything. Medicinal — immune support, antimicrobial. One of the foundational flavor ingredients in virtually every culinary tradition worldwide.

Green Onions / Scallions (*Allium cepa*)

One of the fastest-returning crops in this catalog, and one of the most practical.

Light	Moderate — 4+ hours
Water	Consistently damp
Temperature	60–70°F
Container	4–6" deep; planter boxes or repurposed c
Display	Windowsill, kitchen counter
Growing Season	Year-round indoors

The grocery store trick: Buy a bunch of scallions with roots attached. Trim the greens, place the root ends in a glass of water, and keep on a sunny windowsill. New growth appears within 3–5 days. After 2–3 cycles, transfer to a pot of soil for longer-lived production.

Varieties to Consider

- Evergreen Bunching Onion — Perennial; does not form bulbs; produces continuously from the base
- Tokyo Long White — Slender, mild; excellent for Asian cooking
- Red Baron — Red-tinged; more flavor than white varieties

Uses: Culinary — garnish on almost everything; soups, stir-fry, eggs, tacos, ramen, salads. One of the most frequently used aromatic vegetables in home cooking.



Radishes (*Raphanus sativus*)

25–30 days from seed to harvest. Fastest full-cycle vegetable in the catalog.

Light	Moderate to bright — 4–6 hours
Water	Consistently moist
Temperature	50–70°F preferred
Container	6–8" deep
Display	Windowsill, any bright counter
Growing Season	Year-round; faster in cool season

Varieties to Consider

- Cherry Belle — Classic round red; 22–25 days; reliable
- French Breakfast — Elongated, mild; 25 days; slightly sweeter
- Easter Egg Mix — White, pink, red, and purple roots; fun and ornamental
- Daikon — Long, mild, starchy; 50–60 days; needs deeper container (12")

Uses: Culinary — fresh sliced in salads, on tacos, quick-pickled, roasted. The greens are edible too — use like arugula when young and tender.

Detailed Care

Sow seeds directly, 1" apart, 1/2" deep. Thin to 2–3" spacing after germination — crowded radishes produce all top and no root. Harvest when the shoulder of the root is visible at the soil surface; left too long, they become pithy and tough.

Succession sow every two weeks for continuous harvest.

SECTION TWO: DECORATIVE PLANTS

LOW-LIGHT CHAMPIONS

These plants thrive — or at least survive comfortably — in spaces that most plants would find challenging. North-facing windows, interior rooms, fluorescent office lighting.

Pothos / Devil's Ivy (*Epipremnum aureum*)

The most forgiving houseplant. The one to start with if you've killed every plant you've ever owned.

Light	Tolerates low light; thrives in bright i
Water	When top half of soil is dry
Temperature	65–75°F; tolerates 50°F minimum
Container	Hanging basket, shelf, railing, moss pol
Toxicity	Mildly toxic to pets — causes mouth irri

Varieties

- Golden Pothos — Classic green with gold splashes; most common; excellent starter
- Jade Pothos — All green; best performer in low light; variegated types fade in dim conditions
- Neon Pothos — Electric lime-green; striking; needs more light to maintain color
- Marble Queen — Heavy white variegation; very decorative; needs brighter indirect light
- Satin/Silver Pothos (*Scindapsus pictus*) — Silver-speckled matte leaves; technically a different genus but same care

Display Options: Hang from a hook and let vines trail downward. Mount on a wall with clips. Train up a pole for a vertical column. Set on a high shelf and let cascade. Place in a railing planter on a balcony. This is perhaps the most versatile display plant in this catalog — it works in nearly any configuration.

Detailed Care

Water when the top half of the potting mix is dry — stick a finger 2–3" into the soil. If it feels dry, water thoroughly. If it still feels moist, wait.

Pothos in low light grows slowly and needs even less frequent watering. Reduce water in winter and in dark spaces.

Pinch regularly to keep plants full rather than long and sparse. Cut vines back by a third when they get leggy, or simply redirect them. Cuttings root in water in 1–2 weeks and make excellent gifts or propagation material.

The variegated varieties (Golden, Marble Queen, Neon) lose their color contrast in low light — solid green Jade Pothos is the correct choice for truly dim spaces.

Snake Plant (*Dracaena trifasciata*, formerly *Sansevieria*)

The nearly indestructible plant. Thrives on neglect in a way that feels almost intentional.

Light	Survives low light; grows better in medi
Water	Every 2-4 weeks; allow to dry completely
Temperature	65-75°F ideal; tolerates 50-85°F
Container	Any pot; terracotta preferred to prevent
Toxicity	Mildly toxic to pets — causes vomiting i

Varieties

- Laurentii — Classic; tall with gold-edged leaves; most common
- Moonshine — Pale silver-green; luminous in low light; very elegant
- Futura Robusta — Short and compact; good for smaller spaces
- Black Gold — Dark green with golden edges; dramatic

Display Options: Floor plant in corners with no other plant options. Architectural accent beside furniture. Dark hallway. Low-light bathroom. Office desk under fluorescent lighting.

Detailed Care

The single most important rule: do not overwater. Snake plants store water in their thick, succulent leaves and roots. Sitting in wet soil causes rapid, often fatal root rot. Water thoroughly, then do not water again until the soil is completely dry all the way through. In winter, or in low-light conditions, this can mean watering once per month or less.

Snake plants are one of the few plants that release oxygen at night rather than CO₂, making them genuinely useful in bedrooms.

Propagation by leaf cuttings: cut a leaf into 4" sections and place them upright in water or moist mix. New plants emerge from the base of each cutting. Takes several months.



ZZ Plant (Zamioculcas zamiifolia)

The plant for places nothing else will grow. Offices, dark corners, neglectful owners — it doesn't care.

Light	Thrives in fluorescent light; tolerates
Water	Every 2–3 weeks; allow to dry significan
Temperature	65–75°F; tolerates 50–85°F
Container	Any pot; terracotta prevents overwaterin
Toxicity	Mildly toxic to pets; wash hands after h

Varieties

- Standard Green — Glossy, dark, architectural
- Raven ZZ — Nearly black foliage; one of the most striking houseplants in any light condition
- Zenzi — Dwarf and compact; tightly packed foliage; excellent for small spaces

Display Options: Any dark corner. Office desk. Interior rooms with no windows. Spaces where other plants have consistently failed.

Detailed Care

ZZ plants grow from rhizomes — fat, water-storing underground structures that allow them to survive extended drought. This is the reason for their remarkable low-light, low-water tolerance. It is also the reason they die quickly if waterlogged: the rhizomes rot before any visible damage appears above soil.

Growth is slow, especially in low light. Do not mistake slow growth for an unhealthy plant — this is normal.

Spider Plant (Chlorophytum comosum)

Virtually indestructible, non-toxic, air-purifying, and will produce dozens of offspring. An excellent starter plant.

Light	Adapts from low to bright indirect
Water	Moderate; allow top inch to dry
Temperature	65–75°F; tolerates 55–85°F
Container	Hanging basket; pedestal to show off run
Toxicity	Non-toxic to pets and humans

Varieties

- Vittatum – White center stripe on green leaves; most common
- Variegatum – White margins on green leaves
- Bonnie – Curly, twisted leaves; more compact and unique
- Lemon – Yellow-green foliage; bright and unusual

Display Options: Hanging basket – the cascading runners (which produce baby plantlets) become a feature rather than a management problem. Pedestal where the long arching stems can hang down. High shelf.

Detailed Care

Spider plants produce "babies" – small plantlets that dangle on long runners from the mother plant. These root easily: pin one to a small pot of moist soil while still attached to the runner, or cut it off and place in water. Within 2–3 weeks, roots form. This makes spider plants one of the easiest plants to propagate and share.

Brown tips are common and indicate mineral buildup from tap water. Use filtered or rainwater if possible, or let tap water sit overnight before using (allows chlorine to dissipate).



Peace Lily (Spathiphyllum wallisii)

One of the best air-purifying plants available. Signals its thirst dramatically — and recovers just as dramatically.

Light	Low to bright indirect; fewer blooms in
Water	When top inch is dry; wilts dramatically
Temperature	65–75°F; 60°F minimum
Container	Any pot with drainage
Toxicity	Toxic to pets — calcium oxalate crystals

Varieties

- Power Petite — Compact; suited for smaller spaces
- Sensation — Large variety; can reach 4+ feet; bold statement
- Domino — White variegation on foliage; unusual and decorative

Display Options: Floor plant (Sensation variety). Shelf or table (smaller varieties). Interior rooms with only moderate light.

Detailed Care

Peace lilies are among the few plants that will actually tell you when they need water — they wilt dramatically, with drooping leaves, before any soil-level signs are obvious. They recover quickly after watering. Use this behavior as a guide, but don't wait for it every time — consistent moisture is better for long-term health than repeated wilt-and-recover cycles.

The white "flowers" are actually spathes — modified leaves surrounding the true flower spike. They last for weeks. As they age, they turn green and eventually brown. Remove them at the base when they go fully brown.



Cast Iron Plant (*Aspidistra elatior*)

The darkest-corner solution. One of the only plants that genuinely thrives in deep shade.

Light	Tolerates full shade; prefers partial sh
Water	Every 1–2 weeks; drought-tolerant
Temperature	50–85°F; very wide tolerance
Container	Any pot; floor or shelf
Toxicity	Non-toxic to pets and humans

Display Options: The darkest corner of your apartment. Below-window placement. Spaces that receive only reflected light. Truly the last resort for impossible locations — and it works.

Detailed Care

The cast iron plant is not glamorous. It grows slowly, produces no flowers worth mentioning, and asks almost nothing. What it delivers is reliability in conditions that would kill almost anything else. It will not thrive in bright light — it's evolved for deep forest shade.

MEDIUM-LIGHT PLANTS

Heartleaf Philodendron (Philodendron hederaceum)

Fast-growing, easy, and extremely adaptable. Close competition with pothos for most forgiving vining plant.

Light	Bright indirect preferred; tolerates low
Water	When top inch is dry
Temperature	65–80°F; 55°F minimum
Container	Hanging basket, moss pole, shelf
Toxicity	Toxic to pets and humans — calcium oxala

Varieties

- Heartleaf (Brasil) — Variegated green and yellow; fast-growing; easy
- Lemon Lime — Bright chartreuse foliage; striking color; needs more light for best color
- Micans — Velvety, iridescent foliage in bronze-green; one of the most beautiful trailing plants
- Pink Princess — Splashed pink variegation; highly sought after; needs bright indirect light

Display Options: Same as pothos — hanging, trailing, climbing on a pole, cascading from shelves.

Detailed Care

Philodendrons are generally slightly faster-growing than pothos and equally easy. The velvety Micans and Brasil variegated types make excellent hanging plants with real visual interest.

Propagation in water is extremely easy: a node cutting (a stem piece with at least one leaf and one node — the bump where a leaf meets the stem) roots in 1–2 weeks.



Monstera (Monstera deliciosa)

The iconic split-leaf plant. Bold enough to be a room's focal point.

Light	Bright indirect; avoid direct sun
Water	When top 2" are dry; moderate
Temperature	65–75°F; 60°F minimum
Container	Floor pot with moss pole
Toxicity	Toxic to pets — calcium oxalate

Varieties

- Standard *Monstera deliciosa* — The classic; large split leaves on a mature plant
- *Monstera adansonii* — Swiss cheese vine; smaller leaves, more holes; better for smaller spaces; more of a trailing plant
- *Monstera Thai Constellation* — Variegated cream on green; striking; expensive

Display Options: Floor plant with a moss pole or stake for the aerial roots to grip. Large corner with bright indirect light.

Detail note on the splits: Young plants do not have split leaves — fenestration (the characteristic holes and splits) develops with age and adequate light. A *Monstera* in too little light will produce intact, unlobed leaves indefinitely.

Detailed Care

Monstera grows toward light, and will lean toward a window if not rotated. Rotate the pot quarterly for even growth.

Wipe the large leaves monthly with a damp cloth — dust accumulates quickly on broad leaves and reduces photosynthesis efficiency. The plant will visibly benefit from clean leaves.

Hoya / Wax Plant (Hoya spp.)

Long-lived, drought-tolerant, and produces one of the most fragrant flowers in any houseplant collection – but only when it's ready.

Light	Medium to bright indirect
Water	Very drought-tolerant; water only when p
Temperature	65–75°F; 55°F minimum
Container	Small pot; prefers being slightly rootbo
Toxicity	Non-toxic to pets and humans

Varieties

- Hoya carnosa – Classic; waxy leaves; star-shaped flower clusters with intense fragrance
- Hoya kerrii – Heart-shaped leaves; one of the most popular gift plants; sold as single leaves (which won't produce a full plant) or rooted cuttings (which will)
- Hoya linearis – Thread-like foliage; unusual and beautiful; hanging plant
- Hoya bella – Small leaves; more compact than carnosa; excellent for hanging baskets
- Hoya australis – Large leaves; vigorous grower; similar to carnosa

Display Options: Hanging basket (most hoyas trail or vine). Railing planter. Pole or trellis for climbing varieties.

Detailed Care

Hoyas bloom only on mature plants (typically 4+ years old) and only under specific conditions: bright indirect light and a slight cool period in late fall. Do not repot frequently – they bloom more readily when slightly rootbound. Do not remove old flower spurs (peduncles) after blooming – the plant reblooms from the same point.

The wait is worth it. When a mature Hoya carnosa blooms, the clusters of waxy, star-shaped flowers exude a sweet scent that fills a room.



Calathea / Prayer Plant (Calathea spp., Maranta leuconeura)

Stunning patterned foliage. The leaves fold upward at night — a biological movement called nyctinasty.

Light	Low to bright indirect; no direct sun
Water	Keep moist; use filtered water (sensitive)
Temperature	65–75°F; 60°F minimum; sensitive to cold
Container	Any pot; high humidity environment preferred
Toxicity	Non-toxic to pets and humans

Varieties

- Calathea orbifolia — Large, round, silver-striped leaves; architectural and elegant
- Calathea medallion — Colorful oval leaves; classic calathea look
- Maranta leuconeura (Red Prayer Plant) — Red veins on dark green; one of the most dramatic leaf patterns in any houseplant; more forgiving than calathea
- Ctenanthe Burle Marxii — Named after landscape architect Roberto Burle Marx; graphic striped leaves

The prayer movement: As light decreases at dusk, calathea and maranta leaves fold upward, resembling hands in prayer. They unfold again in the morning. This is worth placing the plant where you'll notice it.

Detailed Care

The main challenge is humidity. Calathea in typical apartment air (30–40% humidity) will develop brown, crispy edges on leaves. To prevent this, use a pebble tray filled with water (the pot sits above, not in, the water), group plants together, or use a humidifier. Bathroom growing works well for calatheas if there's adequate indirect light.

Use filtered water, rainwater, or water left out overnight. Calathea is sensitive to the fluoride and chloramine in municipal water — these cause the characteristic brown-tipped leaves.

African Violet (*Saintpaulia ionantha*)

One of the best flowering houseplants for apartment conditions. Compact, long-blooming, and available in dozens of color combinations.

Light	Bright indirect to fluorescent; 14–16 ho
Water	From below (saucer) or with a long-necked
Temperature	65–75°F; avoid below 60°F and cold draft
Container	Self-watering pots are ideal; African vi
Toxicity	Non-toxic to pets and humans

Varieties: Hundreds. Colors range from white to deep purple, pink, lavender, red, and bicolors. Single-flowered, double-flowered, frilled, and ruffled forms exist. Standard, miniature, and semi-miniature sizes.

Display Options: North or east-facing windowsill. Under fluorescent shop lights or LED grow lights. Bathroom shelf with bright indirect light.

Detailed Care

African violets are finicky about a few specific things. Water on the leaves causes permanent brown spots. Cold water shocks the roots — use room-temperature water. Cold drafts from windows in winter cause deterioration. Temperature fluctuations cause bud failure.

Everything else is easy. They bloom continuously with adequate light, stay compact, and live for years or decades under good care.

Water from below: pour water into the saucer and allow the plant to absorb what it needs for 30 minutes, then empty excess. This keeps leaves dry and prevents crown rot.

Self-watering pots with a bottom reservoir are the best solution for African violets — they maintain consistent moisture automatically.

Propagation: Leaf cutting. Remove a healthy leaf with 1–2" of stem, insert at an angle into moist seed-starting mix, and enclose in a plastic bag. In 8–10 weeks, small plantlets emerge from the base of the leaf cutting. Separate and pot individually when they're large enough to handle.

HIGH-LIGHT AND SUN-LOVING DECORATIVE PLANTS

Succulents and Cacti (various genera)

Near-zero maintenance. Perfect for forgetful waterers or frequent travelers. The plant equivalent of "set it and forget it."

Light	6+ hours direct sun or strong grow light
Water	Thoroughly, then completely dry before w
Temperature	50–85°F; most tolerate wide range
Container	Must have drainage; unglazed terracotta
Toxicity	Varies; Aloe vera toxic if ingested; mos

Best Varieties for Apartments

- Echeveria — Rosette form; endless variety; among the most beautiful succulents; needs bright light for compact shape
- Haworthia — One of the few succulents that tolerate lower light; ideal for east-facing windows
- Jade Plant (Crassula ovata) — Long-lived; tree-like structure; symbolically meaningful in many cultures; can become a multigenerational plant
- Aloe vera — Useful topical medicinal gel; easy; attractive form
- Sedum — Trailing varieties excellent for hanging baskets; varied textures and colors
- Gasteria — Similar to haworthia; low-light tolerant; tough

Display Options: Windowsill in any sunny window. Grouped arrangements — mixed succulents in a single shallow bowl are easy to care for and visually interesting. Terra cotta collection.

Detailed Care

The watering rule bears repeating because overwatering kills more succulents than any other cause: water thoroughly, then do not water again until the soil is completely dry — not just dry at the surface, but all the way through. In winter or low-light conditions, this may mean once per month or less.

Succulents planted in terracotta containers in cactus/succulent mix (which drains fast) with a drainage hole in the pot are structurally set up for success. Succulents in glass containers without drainage holes, in regular potting mix, on a dark shelf — those are structurally set up for rot.

String of Pearls (Senecio rowleyanus) and String of Hearts (Ceropegia woodii)

Two of the most visually distinctive trailing plants available for apartments. Small footprint, dramatic effect.

Light	Bright indirect to bright; avoid intense
Water	Very drought-tolerant; water only when t
Temperature	65–75°F; frost-sensitive
Container	Hanging basket required for display
Toxicity	String of Pearls: non-toxic to pets; Str

String of Pearls — Long stems of perfect spherical bead-like leaves. Cascades 2–3 feet from a hanging pot. Fragrant white flowers on mature plants. Extremely drought-tolerant. Primary risk: overwatering causes rot quickly.

String of Hearts — Heart-shaped leaves on fine, delicate vines. Develops small tubers along the vine. Variegata form has beautiful pink and cream coloring. More forgiving than String of Pearls; slightly more shade-tolerant.

Display: Hanging basket at eye level or above, where the trailing vines can be seen in full length. These plants are specifically designed, in terms of their growth habit, to cascade — don't use them in a ground-level pot.



Orchid — Moth Orchid (Phalaenopsis spp.)

The most beginner-accessible orchid. Blooms for months at a time and will rebloom with proper care.

Light	Bright indirect; east or west window ide
Water	Every 1–2 weeks; fully dry between water
Temperature	65–75°F day; 55–65°F night — the tempera
Container	Orchid pot (slotted for airflow); bark m
Toxicity	Non-toxic to pets and humans

Display Options: Windowsill specimen plant. Shelf display. Bathroom with bright indirect light.

Detailed Care

Phalaenopsis orchids are epiphytes — in nature, they grow on trees, not in soil. Their roots need airflow. Plant in orchid bark, not potting soil, in a pot with drainage holes and ideally slotted sides. Orchid pots with transparent walls allow you to check root health (green roots = well-hydrated; silvery-white = ready to water; brown, mushy = rot).

After blooming, the spike turns brown. Cut it back to the base. Move the plant to a brighter spot with slightly cooler nights (60–65°F at night) for 4–6 weeks. This temperature drop triggers a new bloom spike. When a new green spike emerges, move back to normal conditions and wait.

The most common mistake: treating orchid bark like potting soil and watering on the same schedule. Orchid bark dries much faster than soil and needs less frequent watering as a result.



Aloe Vera (Aloe barbadensis)

Useful, resilient, beautiful, and produces pups that can be potted and given away indefinitely.

Light	6–8 hours direct sun minimum
Water	Very drought-tolerant; water when comple
Temperature	55–80°F; frost-sensitive
Container	Terra cotta with drainage; cactus mix
Toxicity	Gel for topical use only; latex (yellow

Uses: The gel from a broken leaf is a widely-used topical treatment for minor burns, sunburn, skin irritation, and dry skin. It's antibacterial and mildly anti-inflammatory. Keep a plant in the kitchen for burn accidents.

Display Options: Sunny kitchen windowsill. South-facing bedroom window. Part of a succulent arrangement.

Detailed Care

An established aloe in a terracotta pot in cactus mix, in a sunny window, with infrequent watering, needs almost nothing from you. It will produce pups (baby plants from the base) that can be separated and potted individually when they're 3–4" tall.

For harvest: break off a thick outer leaf close to the base. Slice lengthwise to expose the clear gel. Apply to skin directly or scrape out and store in the refrigerator for a few days.

DISPLAY AND DESIGN STRATEGIES FOR SMALL SPACES

Vertical Growing

Limited floor space is not a limitation if you think vertically. A 6-foot section of wall or a corner can support:

- A mounted shelving unit holding 8–12 small to medium pots
- A large hanging basket at ceiling height with trailing vines
- A wall-mounted planter grid for small herbs or succulents
- A climbing plant on a moss pole occupying 1 square foot of floor space

The Window Gradient

Windows are not uniform. The plant closest to the glass, directly in front of the pane, receives the most light. As you move plants back into the room, light intensity drops dramatically — roughly 50% for every few feet from the glass. Use this gradient:

- On the windowsill: herbs, fruiting plants, succulents
- 2–3 feet back: medium-light houseplants (philodendron, pothos, spider plant)
- Interior room: low-light plants only (ZZ, snake plant, cast iron plant)

Grouping for Humidity

Grouping humidity-loving plants together creates a microclimate of higher humidity as the plants transpire water into the surrounding air. Ferns, calathea, peace lily, and orchids placed together will all benefit from each other's presence.

Hanging and Railing

For apartments with balconies or fire escapes (where local codes permit):

- Railing planters for nasturtium, compact herbs, trailing tomatoes, strawberries, and green onions
- Hanging baskets for strawberries (most practical), spider plants, pothos, string of pearls, trailing succulents
- Window boxes for lettuce, herbs, and radishes

SEASONAL GROWING CALENDAR: EDIBLE PLANTS

For indoor apartment growing. Most edible plants in this catalog can be grown year-round indoors, but following natural light cycles gives better results. Adjust timing based on your window direction and local climate.

Plant	Best Start	Peak Harvest	Light Need	Notes
Basil	Mar–Apr (from seed)	June–Sept	High	Succession sow every 3 weeks for continuous harvest
Mint	Any month	Year-round	Medium	Easiest to start from a grocery store cutting
Rosemary	Spring (buy plant)	Year-round	High	Slow from seed; buy a 4" plant
Thyme	Mar–Apr	Year-round once established	High	Takes 2–3 months to reach harvest size
Chives	Feb–Mar (from seed)	Apr–Nov	Medium	Goes dormant in winter; let it rest
Parsley	Mar–Apr	June–Oct	Medium	Slow to germinate (3 weeks); be patient
Cilantro	Sept–Feb	Oct–Mar	Medium	Bolts in heat — grow in cool months
Oregano	Spring	Year-round once established	High	Start from cutting or division for speed
Sage	Spring (buy plant)	Year-round	High	Woody plant; buy established
Cherry Tomatoes	Feb–Mar (from seed)	June–Sept	High	Need 6+ hours direct sun
Compact Peppers	Jan–Feb (from seed)	July–Oct	High	Slow starters; begin early
Lettuce/Greens	Sept–Mar	Oct–Apr	Low–Medium	Too hot in summer near sunny window
Kale	Aug–Sept	Oct–Mar	Medium	Prefers cooler temperatures
Green Onions	Any month	Year-round (cut-and-come-back)	Medium	Regrow from grocery store roots
Radishes	Any month	3–4 weeks after sowing	Medium	Fastest edible crop; great for beginners
Microgreens	Any month	7–14 days after sowing	Low	No window needed; ambient light works
Strawberries	Spring (buy crowns)	May–July (year 2+)	High	First real harvest in second year
Nasturtium	Apr–May	June–Oct	Medium–High	Entirely edible: flowers, leaves, seeds
Dwarf Citrus	Buy year-round	Varies (12–18 months per fruit cycle)	High	Long game; buy fruiting-age plant

Quarterly summary — what to focus on:

- Jan–Mar: Start tomato and pepper seeds indoors. Sow parsley, chives, basil. Continue harvesting winter greens. Repot any rootbound plants.

- Apr–Jun: Move warm-season plants to brightest windows. Start nasturtium. Succession-sow basil. Harvest spring lettuce before it bolts.
- Jul–Sept: Peak harvest for tomatoes, peppers, herbs. Start fall lettuce and kale. Plant cilantro for cool-season growth. Watch for spider mites in dry summer air.
- Oct–Dec: Harvest greens, kale, cilantro. Reduce watering for dormant herbs. Grow microgreens for fresh nutrition when nothing else is producing. Order seeds for spring.

QUICK REFERENCE: PLANTS BY CHALLENGE LEVEL

Can't-Kill (Start Here)

Snake Plant, ZZ Plant, Pothos, Cast Iron Plant, Succulents, Chives

Low Maintenance, High Reward

Spider Plant, Philodendron, Aloe Vera, Hoya, Green Onions, Radishes, Microgreens

Rewarding with Some Attention

Basil, Mint, Orchid, Calathea, Lettuce, Nasturtium, Strawberries

Committed Growing (You're Ready)

Cherry Tomatoes, Peppers, Dwarf Citrus, Rosemary, African Violet

QUICK REFERENCE: PET-SAFE PLANTS

Safe for Pets (Confirmed Non-Toxic)

Spider Plant, Boston Fern, Hoya, African Violet, Air Plants (Tillandsia), Orchid, Aloe Vera (external only), Haworthia, Strawberries, all culinary herbs (except large amounts)

Toxic to Pets – Use with Caution

Pothos, Philodendron, Monstera, Peace Lily, Snake Plant, Dracaena, ZZ Plant, Aloe Vera (if ingested), Chinese Evergreen, String of Hearts

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More from Seedwarden

If you found this guide useful, you might also like:

- Apartment Seed Starting Kit (\$9) — Start every plant in this catalog from seed with minimal equipment
- Container Growing Blueprint Pack (\$12) — Printable layout plans for arranging containers on balconies and patios

- 12-Month Urban Growing Planner (\$7) — Week-by-week schedule for indoor and small-space growing year-round

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